CS185
GR4 W26

Focusing !

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Focusing !
Lowering the emotional barrier to deep work through a quiet, non judgmental presence

We chose **Focusing!** because it represents the active, ongoing state of deep work we want to facilitate.The "!" reflects the energy and encouragement provided by the presence of our companion

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Problem/solution overview

Self-directed work often fails because motivation **snaps** when progress feels invisible and external accountability is absent. **Focusing!** addresses this emotional hurdle by providing a quiet, non-judgmental presence that lowers the barrier to starting and sustaining difficult tasks.

Primary User

- **Self-directed students and remote workers**
- **Independent professionals**

Main Problem

- **Motivation Collapse:** Motivation often snaps suddenly when progress feels invisible and external feedback is absent.
- **Accountability Vacuum:** Without a social gaze,"internal willpower alone is often insufficient to combat distractions.

Solution

- **Focusing!:** A low-pressure presence companion that provides quiet, non-interactive support.

Market research

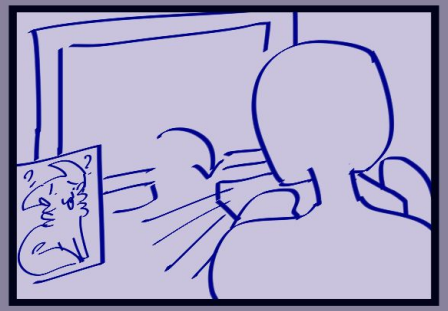
	Focusing!	Focusmate	Forest
Pressure	**Low**: A non interactive presence designed to offer quiet companionship without reminders or performance tracking.	**High:** Requires real time video interaction with a human partner, creating strong external accountability.	**Moderate:** Uses streak mechanics and character growth to motivate, which can trigger guilt if a focus session is broken.
Accountability Style	**Emotional Body Doubling**: Focuses on reducing the isolation of solo work to lower the emotional barrier of tasks.	**Social Gaze:** Replicates the environment of a library or office by having another person watch you work.	**Gamification:** Replaces external pressure with internal achievement through digital rewards and feedback loops.
Re-Entry Friction	**Low:** Uses intentional rituals to help users restart work after a distraction without relying on urgency or guilt.	**High:** Limited by scheduled appointment times; missing a window can lead to a total loss of focused time for that hour.	**Moderate:** Allows users to restart immediately, but often penalizes them with "dead trees" or lost progress, increasing the emotional cost of failure.

Tasks

Task	Complexity	Reasoning	Video Timestamp
Establishing a Supported Workspace	Simple	The essential first step for any session; involves the user mentally preparing their environment and signaling an intent to begin.	0:00 - 0:18
Navigating an Emotional Distraction	Moderate	Addresses the "Anxiety Loop" where a user must navigate the emotional friction of putting down a distraction to return to a difficult task.	0:18 - 0:32
Sustaining High-Cognitive Focus	Complex	The core value proposition; requires the user to maintain deep concentration on a solo task when internal willpower is most likely to fail.	0:38 - 1:43
Validating Invisible Progress	Simple	Closes the "Feedback Vacuum" by allowing the user to acknowledge invisible progress and experience a sense of achievement.	1:43 - 1:45

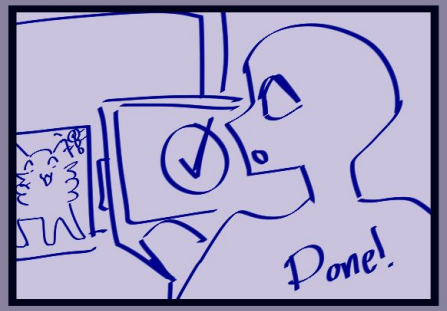
Birds or nature sounds in bg?
unopened device
start work~
try starting, then...
distracted, hard to stat
but buddy is here!
Back to work~
time passes by...
stretch
still here for you~
still focusrd!

nervous



Still here for you~

Back at it again!


Done!

All thanks to you~

Fin~

Youtube Video